

Automating Call Quality at Acquia

How a two-day automation project transformed customer operations from manual chaos to systematic excellence—saving 85% of administrative time while dramatically improving quality and visibility.



The Manual Operations Problem

Acqira's Accelerator Program guides clients through an intensive 8-18 month journey to acquire businesses. Andi manages the entire operation —onboarding new clients, conducting detailed deal reviews, tracking progress milestones, and ensuring customer satisfaction at every touchpoint.

While the operations were structured with clear processes in place, execution remained painfully manual. The team had systems, but they depended entirely on human memory and consistency.



Pain Points Threatening Quality

Recording Gaps

Call recordings happened inconsistently, depending entirely on who remembered to press record. Critical conversations were lost forever, making follow-up and quality reviews impossible.

Time Drain

The team spent over 30 minutes after each call hunting down notes, reconstructing conversations from memory, and documenting what happened. This administrative burden ate into time that could be spent helping clients.

Zero Visibility

Nobody knew what actually happened on calls unless they were there. Managers couldn't coach effectively, team members couldn't provide informed handoffs, and patterns were invisible.

Unclear Next Steps

Account Executives often ended calls without crystal-clear action items. Clients were left wondering what to do next, creating confusion and slowing down the acquisition journey.

Inconsistent Quality

Quality varied wildly depending on who led the call. At least one customer complained about expectations not being properly set—a red flag that the manual approach was failing.

Scattered Information

Critical details lived in different systems, various documents, or simply in people's memories. When team members were unavailable, their knowledge became inaccessible to everyone else.



The Catalyst for Change

Hayden suggested a "mini project" to solve the visibility problem: automatically record, analyze, and track every customer call to ensure consistent quality without manual work.

What started as a simple suggestion to improve visibility became a complete transformation of how the operations team works. The goal was ambitious but clear: make every call visible, measurable, and actionable—without adding work for the team.

Building the Automation Recipe

01

Define Success in Two Days

Set a clear vision: document every call automatically, reinforce SOP quality standards, and ensure every client leaves with confidence about their next steps. The tight timeline forced focus on what truly mattered.

02

Update the Foundation First

Before automating anything, the team revised their Standard Operating Procedures to explicitly define quality. They documented which topics must be covered, what questions to ask, and what next steps to establish—creating a measurable standard.

03

Select the Right Tools

The team chose a practical tech stack that worked together seamlessly: Bubbles Note Taker for automatic recording and transcription, Zapier to connect everything without coding, Google Sheets and Drive for centralized storage, ChatGPT via Zapier for intelligent analysis, and Slack for instant team notifications.

The 10-Step Automation Workflow

1

Trigger & Filter

When Bubbles finishes recording, it signals Zapier. The system filters to process only "Onboarding" or "Deal Review" calls—the high-stakes conversations that need quality tracking.

2

Capture & Store

Call details are logged to Google Sheet. The full transcript is downloaded from Bubbles and saved to organized Drive folders. Everything is stored in one searchable location.

3

AI Analysis

ChatGPT analyzes the transcript against the SOP checklist: Was platform access confirmed? Deal flow explained? Financial documents discussed? Follow-up scheduled? Each item gets scored (1 = covered, 0 = missed).

4

Share & Alert

Results are written back to the sheet for tracking. A Slack notification with the analysis summary goes to the team instantly, ensuring everyone has visibility within minutes of the call ending.

Problem-Solving in Action

The path wasn't smooth. Text files didn't work with ChatGPT, so the team pivoted to Google Docs. N8N didn't support Bubbles integration, so they switched to Zapier. Each obstacle was solved with creative workarounds.





THE IMPACT

Measurable Results Across the Board

85%

Time Savings

Reduction in administrative work per call—from 30+ minutes down to just 5 minutes for verification

100%

Call Coverage

Every single call is now automatically recorded, transcribed, and analyzed with zero manual effort

2

Build Timeline

Days from concept to fully operational system—proving automation doesn't require months of development

Transforming Visibility and Quality

From Scattered to Centralized

Before: Information lived in different places, dependent on individual memory, inaccessible when team members were unavailable.

After: Real-time team-wide visibility through Slack notifications and centralized tracking. Everyone knows what happened on every call.

From Subjective to Objective

Before: No way to verify which topics were covered until customers complained about gaps in communication or expectations.

After: Objective scoring on every single call, immediate identification of gaps, and data-driven coaching opportunities for continuous improvement.

From Reactive to Proactive

Before: Quality issues surfaced only through customer complaints, making it impossible to course-correct before damage was done.

After: Proactive quality monitoring catches issues immediately, allowing the team to follow up and fix gaps before clients even notice.

Wins for Clients and Team

Client Experience Improvements

- **Consistency:** Every client receives the same high-quality experience regardless of which team member they work with
- **Clarity:** Clear next steps are documented and communicated every single time, eliminating confusion
- **Follow-through:** Nothing falls through the cracks—the system ensures every commitment is tracked and delivered

Team Benefits

- **Better Preparation:** Complete context available before follow-up calls, enabling more productive conversations
- **Reduced Stress:** No more anxiety about whether calls were recorded or notes were captured correctly
- **Shared Knowledge:** Information is accessible to everyone—no single point of failure when someone is out
- **Continuous Improvement:** Data-driven insights enable coaching and process refinement based on patterns, not guesswork



Key Takeaways for Your Automation Journey

1

Start with the Problem, Not the Tools

Acqira identified specific pain points—visibility gaps, time waste, quality inconsistency—before choosing technology. The tools served the solution, not the other way around.

2

Document Standards Before Automating

Updating the SOPs first created a clear quality benchmark. You can't automate quality checking if you haven't defined what quality looks like.

3

Embrace No-Code Solutions

Zapier, Google Sheets, and ChatGPT integration required zero custom development. Modern no-code tools can solve complex workflows in days, not months.

4

Iterate Through Obstacles

When text files failed, they tried Google Docs. When N8N didn't work, they switched to Zapier. Success came from persistence and creative problem-solving, not a perfect first attempt.

5

Measure Impact Relentlessly

The 85% time savings and quality improvements aren't abstract—they're measurable, documentable wins that justify the investment and inspire future automation projects.

Automation isn't about replacing people—it's about freeing them from manual work so they can focus on what humans do best: building relationships, solving complex problems, and delivering exceptional customer experiences.